owned and run by brothers Atul and Rahul Kirloskar, and the other by Sanjay Kirloskar. Gauri Kirloskar is part of Atul & Rahul's branch, while Rama Kirloskar (*more on her later*) belongs to the other branch led by Sanjay.

According to Kavil Ramachandran, former Professor of Family Business and Entrepreneurship at the Indian School of Business, changes in the external environment have helped bring about this shift. While the overall levels of education have sharply improved, shift from joint families to nuclear families meant there were fewer hands available to join the business as it grew; and in some cases, this did make it easier for women to enter the business.

Family-owned enterprises have always been at the heart of Indian industry. A 2024 McKinsey study said that in India, family-owned businesses contribute more than 75% of national GDP, one of the highest percentages in the world, with this contribution likely to rise to over 80% by 2047. This spans the entire spectrum from large to small and medium enterprises. Legal amendments like the Hindu Succession Act 2005 have also resulted in an increase in the number of women getting actively involved in businesses.

Most times, the patriarch and family are supportive of the daughter's decision to join the business. The challenge is managing the old guard —senior managers who have spent decades at the organisation and find it difficult to accept the newcomer as a peer.

"They see the person as the MD's daughter and not somebody with merit or a qualified individual with capabilities. She has to establish herself in this set-up and it may be challenging if she doesn't always get the space to do it," says Ramachandran.

Sometimes, the way families approach succession planning also com-



"WE ARE CARRYING THE LEGACY FORWARD AND PROTECTING IT FOR THOSE WHO FOLLOW US"

**PRITI SUREKA**
WHOLE-TIME DIRECTOR, EMAMI

- **Chairperson of CRI Tips, the group's ball-point pen manufacturing business**
- **Revived the legacy BoroPlus brand and led the expansion into other product segments**
- **Acquired Kesh Kala to foray into the haircare segment; leads the R&D and Market Innovation & Market Insights divisions of the FMCG business**
- **In 2025, was elected President of the Merchants' Chamber of Commerce and Industry**